model of development and reflection of collective efforts," he said.

THE BIGGER PICTURE

Dr Pramod Sawant said he was moved by the plight of grandmothers of remote villages who cannot visit bigger towns, widowed mothers in need of assistance to manage their lives and supplement their livelihoods, and people with disabilities in need of last-mile support. He believes the goal of self-reliance can only be reached if every last person - irrespective of caste and creed - receives the benefits of these initiatives.

He said, "The initiative was launched to make the application process for schemes swift. People in Goa are aware of schemes such as Griha Aadhar (for housewives), Laadli Laxmi (for girl child) and the Deen Dayal Swasthya Seva Yojana (for health). But they do not know of any others. I want them to know and apply for these 150 schemes. Information about them and applications are available on the Goaonline web portal. We aim to fulfil our promises including housing, water, electricity and insurance for all. Along with schemes and services, we want people to gain employment via our model career centres."

HOW IT WORKS

An extensive study conducted by the Directorate of Higher Education and Goa Institute of Public Administration and Rural Development helped understand the strengths, weaknesses, opportunities and threats in all 191 Panchayats in Goa. It also investigated the available resources and talents that could help revitalise the village economy.

Findings indicated that although Goa offers one of the highest subsidies in India for farming, there is poor response due to lack of awareness and low motivation among youngsters to participate in this occupation.

Residents of villages and municipalities are offered the opportunity to put forth their grievances before government representatives on a designated day. Information about various schemes, services and welfare programmes will be disbursed at dedicated counters.

The programme aims to offer prompt solutions to frequent problems faced by Goans, including roads, water supply, electricity and other basic amenities. Through the day, pending applications and dues on Ration cards, Aadhar cards, voter ID cards, Kisan cards, Dayanand Social Security scheme, Irrigation scheme and Tribal Welfare schemes will be processed.

Services available through the Swayampurna Goa initiative include issuance of residence certificates, ration cards, income certificates and beneficiary cards from Goa Electronics Limited; Deen Dayal Swasthya Seva Yojana; Griha Aadhar; social welfare schemes; electricity connections and issues; water connections; household toilets; mutation, partition and conversion of land; agricultural welfare schemes; child project development welfare schemes; labour welfare schemes and issues; veterinary schemes; lead banks, Atal Insurance and credit card facilities; and schemes related to tribal welfare, fisheries, the Economic Development Corporation, Water Resources, Public Works Department and towards the welfare of the economically weaker sections of society.

PROGRESS SO FAR

The aim in October 2021 was for 10 main targets including water and electricity connections, shelter and sanitation for all homes, beneficiary cards for farmers, aid for people with disabilities and senior citizens, as well as health, social and financial security for vulnerable sections of society to be covered.

During his visit to Goa, Prime Minister Narendra Modi presented awards to the best performing panchayats, municipalities and state government officers called "Swayampurna Mitras." He had earlier interacted with beneficiaries and stakeholders of the Swayampurna Goa initiative and discovered how thousands of people were already benefiting from it.

In villages across Goa, there are success stories of women's empowerment, medical treatment for those unable to afford it, free medical check-ups, training and machinery given to self-help groups, aid to people with disabilities and tribals, vaccination awareness, assistance to farmers and fisherfolk, beneficiary cards, provisions for toilets, water and electricity connections, waste management systems, solar energy and even promotion of eco-tourism.

The second phase of the Swayampurna Goa initiative began in October 2021 and will run until October 2022 when the third phase kicks off. Prime Minister Narendra Modi pointed out, "The Swayampurna Goa initiative is not a programme of five months or five years, but the first phase of a vision for the next 25 years. All the people should come together for this. With the blessings of the whole state, we will fulfil the goal of Swayampurna Goa."

AWARDS & ACCOLADES RECEIVED BY GOA

STATE OF STATES

- Named Best Performing Small State overall for the third consecutive year at India Today's State of States Conclave 2020
- Named Best Performing Small State in Economy, Tourism and Infrastructure categories

INFRASTRUCTURE

- Certified Open Defecation Free by Quality Control of India, as part of the Swachh Bharat Mission

TOURISM

- Awarded Best Tourism Destination in 2019
- Awarded National Award for Tourism
- First Indian state to receive a Safe Travels stamp from World Travel & Tourism Council, India Initiative

EMPLOYMENT

- Ranked 1st in India in Facilitating Innovation by the 2019-20 India Innovation Index Report
- Ranked 6th in India in terms of Innovative Approach by the 2019-20 India Innovation Index Report

EDUCATION

- Indian Institute of Technology established in Goa
- 40% of all seats in National Institute of Technology Goa reserved for Goan students

LAW & ORDER

- Goa Police awarded the FICCI Smart Policing Awards in 2016 & 2018 for commendable performance in community policing